

Google presents: The new, improved world

It wouldn't be an exaggeration to say that Larry Page and Sergey Brin changed the way we use the Internet. But are they gonna change the world, too?

The company's pre-IPO document specified the setting up of Google Foundation, an institution that will strive to "make the world a better place". The document was meant for stock market regulators to be introduced to many undisclosed details.

Google informed potential investors in the document sent to the Securities and Exchange Commission (the American counterpart of SEBI) that they "intend to contribute significant resources to the foundation, including employee time and approximately one per cent of Google's equity and

profits in some form."

The two Stanford PhDs wrote: "We hope someday this institution may eclipse Google itself in terms of overall world impact by ambitiously applying innovation and significant resources to the largest of the world's problems." Noble intentions ooze from Google all the time (remember "We don't do evil"?), besides a foundation would also add another level of public disclosure to the world's largest search company, which has, for the last six years, enjoyed the relative secrecy of a privately held corporation. Google earned nearly \$106 million last year. For the three months ending in March 31,



2004, they earned \$64 million on revenue of about \$390 million, 30 per cent of which was derived from outside the United States.

Which is not bad for a company that put Sherlock Holmes to shame with its search algorithms.

Do you think Google should stick to search, or should they heal the world? Tell us at www.thinkdigit.com

I want my MTV online!

Popular television network MTV is now girding its loins and getting ready for the big battle. And this time, it WILL be big.

Right now, as industry pundits would tell us, the biggest music battles are

being fought not in the studios, but on the Internet. After the super-successful launch of Apple's iTunes, it was only a matter of time before others got into the ring. With television industry leader MTV tying

up with RealNetworks and three other labels, the share for the music downloads pie may get smaller by the day.

The partnership is called MusicNet, and the service will charge \$1 per song, while a month's usage will cost \$10.

Hum Aapke Hain Clone

Normally, movies create a stir because of excess sex, or violence, or even racial abuse. But a Web site meant to promote the film *Godsend* has raised the heckles of those opposed to human cloning.

The film stars Oscar nominee Greg Kinnear and Rebecca Romijn-Stamos (whose ex-husband John Stamos starred in *Full House*) as a couple who lose their son. With the help of fertility expert Dr Richard Wells (played by Robert De

Niro), they try to clone their son. The Web site—godsendinstitute.org—promotes a fictitious fertility clinic. The confusion arises because it does



not mention the movie.

Web surfers have petitioned on the grounds that it is insensitive to those who have lost a loved one, and are seeking to clone.

Tom Ortenberg, president of film releasing for Lions Gate Entertainment claims, "Everyone who goes to the site thinks it's real, but by the time they leave, most have it figured. Some even applaud it."

heroes

E-mail users

Web portal Lycos has followed Google and Yahoo! in the race to provide e-mail users huge storage.

Lycos is upgrading its service in the UK to give consumers 1 GB mailboxes. But users will have to pay a monthly fee of Rs 275.80.

While Google's Gmail is still in a test phase, Spymac, a Web-hosting company for Macintosh aficionados, has also announced a free 1 GB.

Fedora RedHat

Fedora Beta 1.92, release 3, has a fundamentally different security model. Fedora Core now includes Security Enhanced Linux. SELinux is disabled by default. To enable, type 'selinux' at the Boot prompt.

Before doing that, it is imperative to memorise the Fedora Core SELinux FAQ.

zeroes

Net-banking

At an online survey, 75 per cent said they were less likely to shop online because of phishing. Over 65 per cent expressed fears about their bank's online service. Only a third of the 650 respondents felt they could distinguish between a real e-mail and a fishy one.

Corel WordPerfect 12

Corel's new WordPerfect 12 update is hardly worth the \$150 price it demands. It has a cluttered interface, non-intuitive menu structure and an extremely buggy compatibility feature that fails to handle Microsoft Office and HTML.